Informatica® Cloud Application Integration
November 2025

AI Agent for Slack with MCP Tool Support

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Publication Date: 2025-10-27

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Preface

Use *AI Agent for Slack with MCP Tool Support* to learn how to receive user queries from Slack. When a user sends a query, it is sent to OpenAI, which calls the MCP server. The MCP server searches for relevant context, sends the query along with the context to the Large Language Model (LLM), and returns the response to the Slack channel.

CHAPTER 1

Introduction to AI Agent for Slack with MCP Tool Support recipe

The AI Agent for Slack with MCP Tool Support recipe is based on REST APIs. Use the recipe to receive user queries from Slack. When a user sends a query, it is forwarded to OpenAI, which calls the MCP server. The MCP server searches for relevant context, sends the query along with that context to the Large Language Model (LLM), and returns the generated response to the Slack channel.

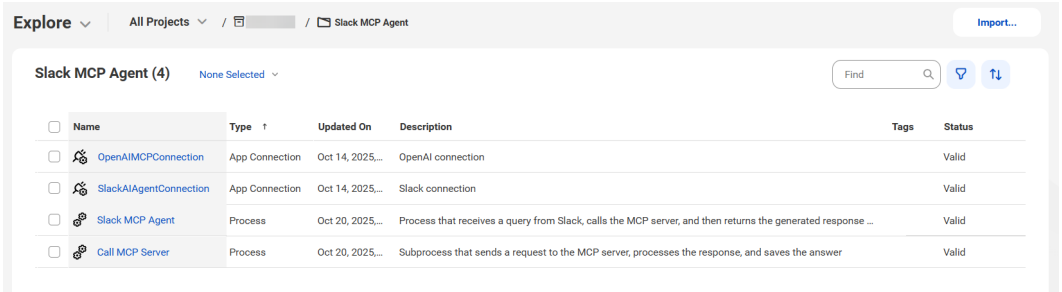
The process accepts user input from Slack but ignores messages sent by bots. It also reviews the Slack channel's history from the previous day and calls the LLM to summarize the history. If relevant information is found, it is used as additional context. When sufficient, the LLM generates an answer based on history alone.

The LLM then calls the MCP server with the user input, either including relevant historical context or using the input alone. The LLM leverages this information to generate a comprehensive response. This response is returned to the user in the same Slack channel as a bot or app response.

AI Agent for Slack with MCP Tool Support recipe contents

The AI Agent for Slack with MCP Tool Support recipe contains app connections and processes.

The following image shows the assets that the AI Agent for Slack with MCP Tool Support recipe package contains:



AI Agent for Slack with MCP Tool Support recipe assets

The following table lists the assets that the AI Agent for Slack with MCP Tool Support recipe package contains:

Asset Name	Asset Type	Description
OpenAIMCPConnection	App Connection	OpenAI connection.
SlackAIAgentConnection	App Connection	Slack connection.
Call MCP Server	Process	Subprocess that sends a request to the MCP server, processes the response, and saves the answer.
Slack MCP Agent	Process	Process that receives a query from Slack, calls the MCP server, and then returns the generated response to the Slack channel.

CHAPTER 2

Using the AI Agent for Slack with MCP Tool Support recipe

To use the AI Agent for Slack with MCP Tool Support recipe, you must perform the following steps manually:

1. Copy and access the recipe.
2. Configure and publish the OpenAI connection.
3. Configure and publish the Slack connection.
4. Configure and publish the processes.
5. Create webhook in Slack.

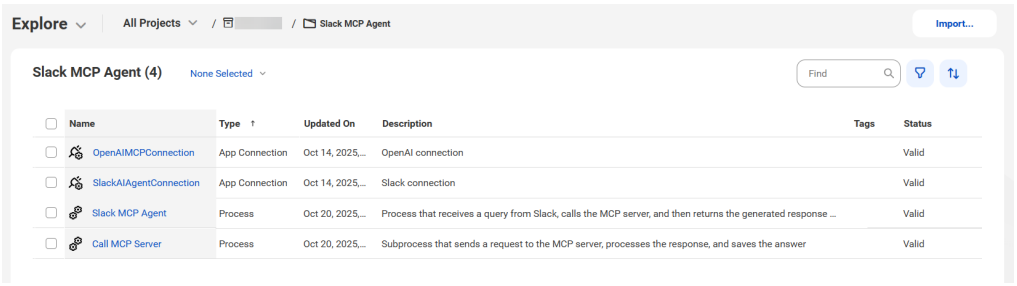
Step 1. Copy and access the recipe

Copy the pre-configured assets in the recipe to a separate project or folder.

1. Open the **AI Agent for Slack with MCP Tool Support** recipe and click **Use**.
2. Select the location where you want to copy the recipe, and then click **Continue**.
3. In the **Copying the recipe** dialog box, click **OK**.

   It might take some time for the recipe to get copied. You will receive a notification when the recipe is ready for use.
4. After the recipe is copied, click **Explore** to access the recipe content.
5. Navigate to the project or folder where you copied the recipe or enter the recipe name in the **Find** box.

   All the assets in the recipe are displayed as shown in the following image:



Step 2. Configure and publish the OpenAI connection

Configure the API key to authenticate OpenAI connection requests, and then publish the OpenAIMCPConnection connection.

1. Open the **OpenAIMCPConnection** connection.
2. From the **Type** list, select **OpenAI**.
3. From the **Runtime Environment** list, select **Cloud Server or any Secure Agent**.
4. In the **Connection Properties** section, enter the API key in the **API_Key** property in the **Connection Properties** section. The OpenAI API uses the API key to authenticate OpenAI connection requests.
5. Save and publish the connection.

Step 3. Configure and publish the Slack connection

Configure the base URL to access the Slack instance, and then publish the SlackAIAgentConnection connection.

1. Open the **SlackAIAgentConnection** connection.
2. From the **Type** list, select **Slack**.
3. From the **Runtime Environment** list, select **Cloud Server or any Secure Agent**.
4. From the **Authentication Type** list, select **OAuth2** and enter values for the following properties:

Property	Description
Grant Type	Required. Select the required grant type based on your use case.
Authorization URL	Required. Enter the OAuth authorization URL for the OAuth provider to authorize the user request. For example: `https://slack.com/oauth/v2/authorize`
Token Request URL	Required. Enter the OAuth token request URL that handles token requests. For example: `https://slack.com/api/oauth.v2.access` The expiration of the refresh token depends on the OAuth provider. You must re-authenticate and publish the connection before the token expires. **Note:** The refresh token doesn't apply to agents and agent groups.
Client ID	Required. Specify the identifier value from the OAuth provider.
Client Secret	Required. Enter the client secret to connect to the OAuth provider.
Scope	Required. Specify the scope. The scope in OAuth authentication limits an application's access to a user's account. You can select multiple scopes for a single client. To enter multiple scopes, separate each value with a space.
Session duration	Optional. Enter the number of minutes to wait before refreshing the session. This is used if you cannot obtain the token expiration from the OAuth provider. Default is 60 minutes.

Property	Description
Other Parameters	Optional. Enter parameters to customize the authorization request, separated with semicolons. You can provide extra information or specify requirements of the OAuth provider.
Authorization Status	Optional. Indicates the current status, the name of the user who authorized, and the last time when the authorization was completed.
Authorize Access	Click to initiate the authorization workflow using OAuth.

5. In the **Connection Properties** section, enter the base URL in the **Base_URL** property. The base URL connects to the Slack API and sets the primary endpoint for all Slack requests.
6. Save and publish the connection.

Step 4. Configure and publish the processes

Configure the LLM model, server host, and server label for the MCP server, and then publish the processes.

1. Open the **Call MCP Server** process.
2. On the **Assignments** tab of the **Set Server Configuration** step, enter the LLM model, server host, and server label values for the MCP server.
3. Save and publish the process.
4. Open the **Slack MCP Agent** process.
5. On the **Start** tab of the **Start** step, select **Allow anonymous access**.
6. Save and publish the process.
7. On the **Actions** menu, click **Properties Detail** and copy the service URL.
   You will need this process URL to set up the Slack webhook.

Step 5. Create webhooks in Slack

Configure a Slack app that calls an API when a new message arrives.

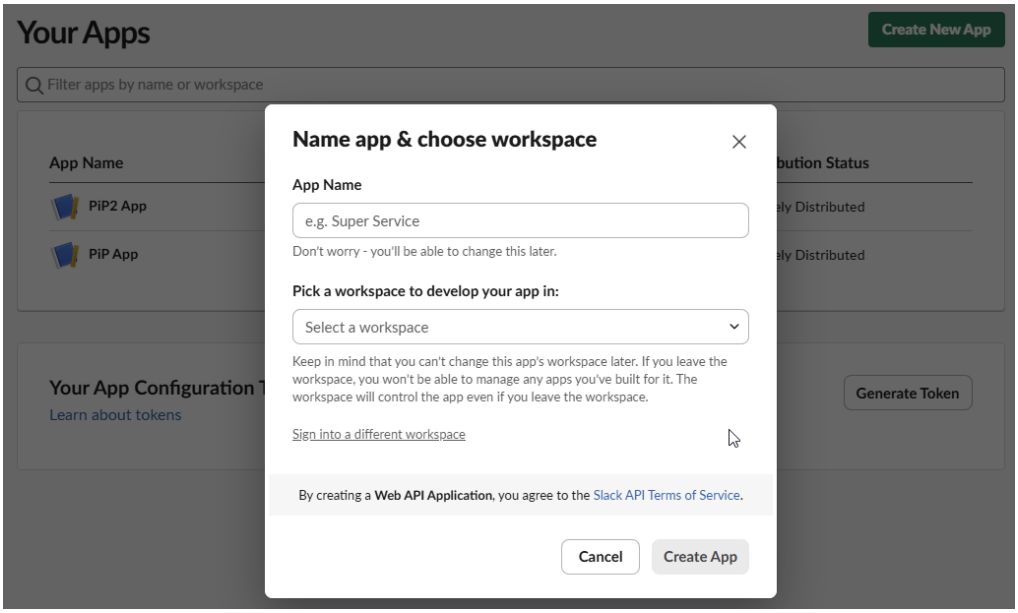
To create a webhook in Slack, perform the following steps:

1. “Create a Slack App” on page 10
2. “Enable the events API” on page 11
3. “Subscribe to the event” on page 12
4. “Set the required OAuth scopes” on page 13
5. “Enable token rotation” on page 14
6. “Add bot to a channel” on page 15

Create a Slack App

1. Go to `https://api.slack.com/apps` and log in to your account.

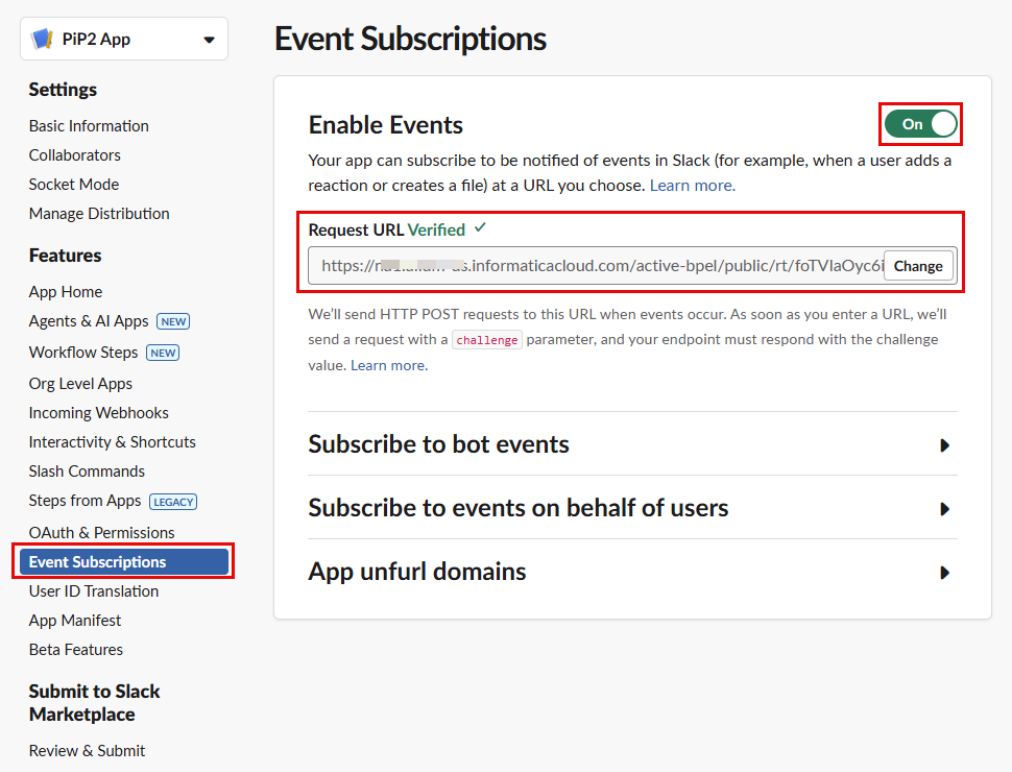
2. Click **Create New App** > **From scratch**.
3. Enter the app name and select your workspace, and then click **Create App** as shown in the following image:



Enable the events API

1. From the left navigation bar, go to **Event Subscriptions**.
2. Turn on the toggle switch to enable events.

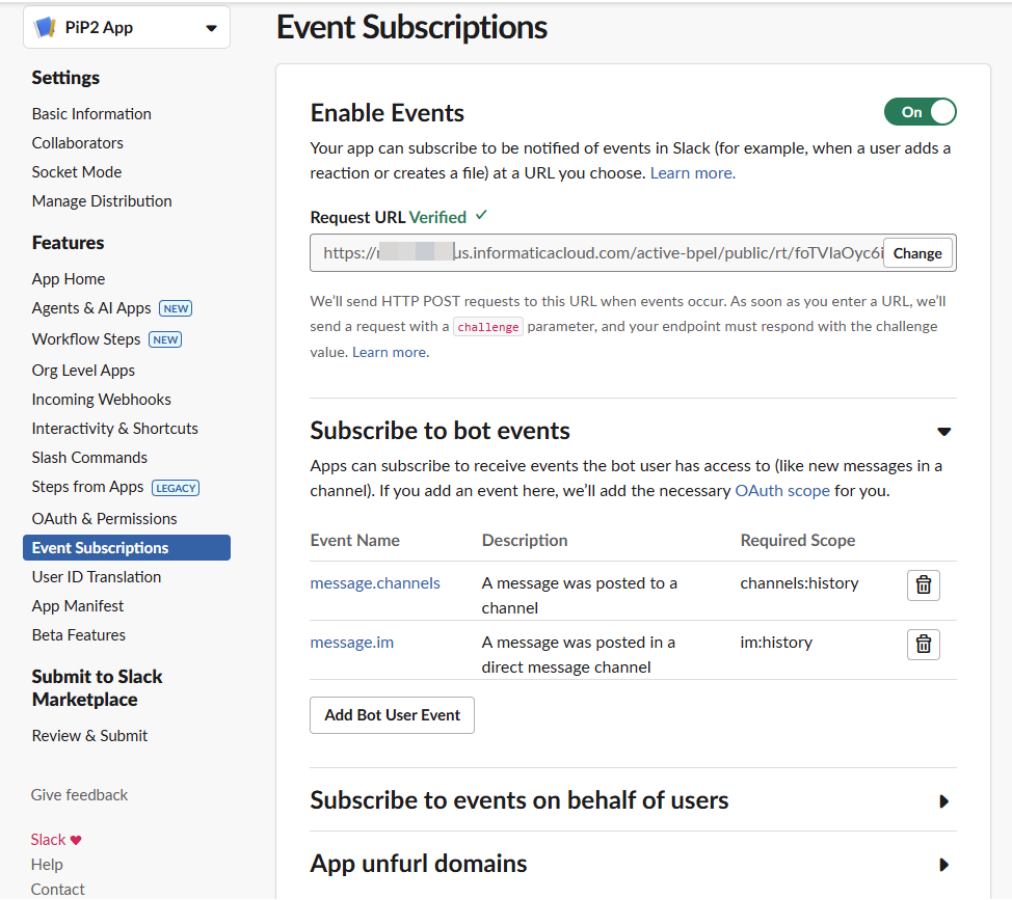
3. In the **Request URL** field, enter the service URL that you get after publishing the process. Slack sends a `challenge` request to verify the URL as shown in the following image:



Subscribe to the event

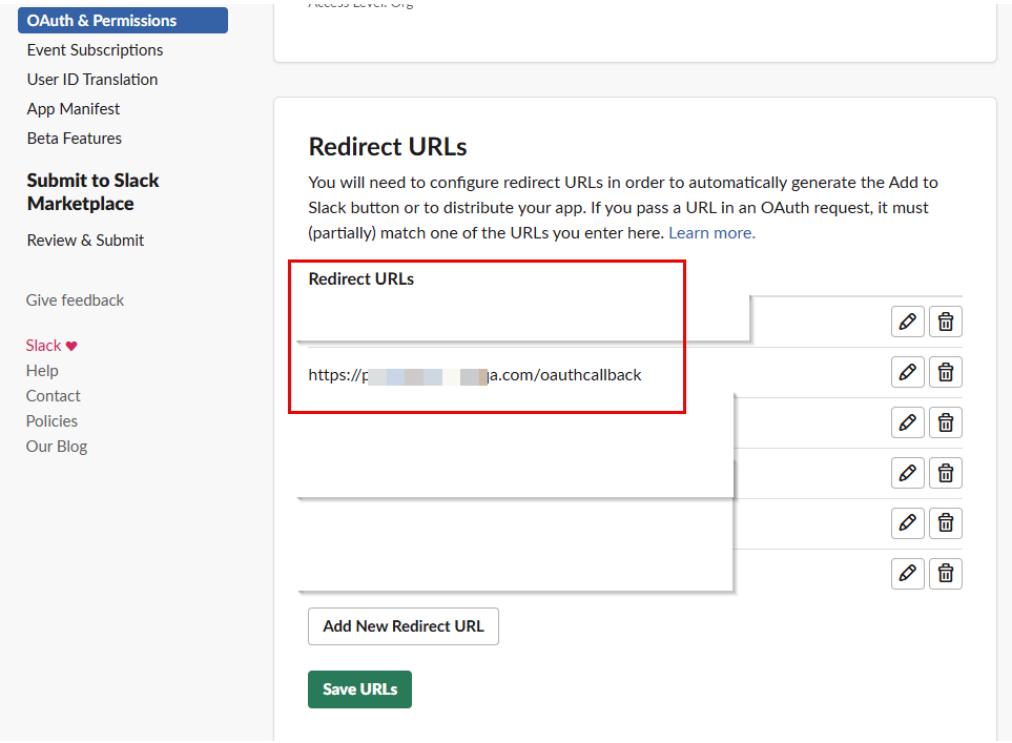
1. In the **Subscribe to bot events** section, click **Add Bot User Event** and add one of the following events as required:
   - `message.channels` — to receive messages from public channels.
   - `message.groups` — for private channels.

   The event allows your app to receive messages from channels it belongs to as shown in the following image:



Set the required OAuth scopes

1. Go to **OAuth & Permissions**.
2. In the **Bot Token Scopes** section, click **Add an OAuth Scope** and add one of the following OAuth scopes:
   - `channels:history` — to read public channel messages.
   - `groups:history` — to read messages from private channels, if needed.
   - `chat:write` — if your bot needs to send messages.
3. In the **Redirect URLs** section, click **Add New Redirect URL** and add the redirect URLs in `<Cloud Application Integration POD URL>/oauthcallback` format and save the URLs. For example, `https://na1.dm-us.informaticacloud.com/oauthcallback` as shown in the following image:

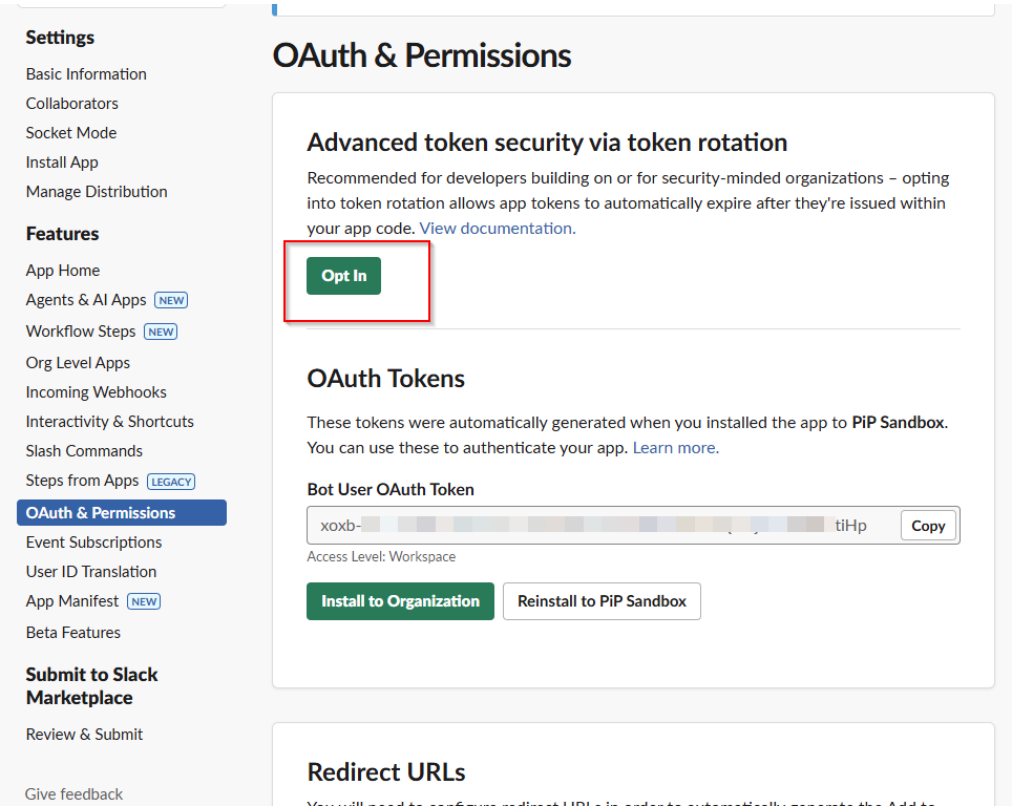


4. Install the app using the **Install App** section.

Enable token rotation

1. Go to **OAuth & Permissions**.

2. In the **Advanced token security via token rotation** section, click **Opt In**.



Add bot to a channel

1. In Slack, go to the required channel.
2. Invite the bot using `/invite @<your-bot-name>`.